

what's kind and loving for others. If saying yes means overcommitting, feeling stressed, adding strain, or flat-out leading to exhaustion, you will not be showing up as your best self. And no one needs that. A simple "No, that's not gonna work for me" will usually suffice, but you can also try the "but" trick. As in saying, "No, BUT . . ." Essentially saying no to the original request but offering an alternative that will work for you and is a good compromise.

Prioritizing activities: Time is more limited than money. So, just like we need to prioritize what we spend on, we also need to prioritize how we spend our time. When there are a million things to be doing and only one of you, it's helpful to list it all out and consider each item in order of importance *and* time requirement. Once it's all listed, go back through and number them in order of importance and plan when each item will happen or if it's something that can't happen. This will require accepting that some things on that list will NOT get done. And that's OK. We can allow our abilities and limitations to inform us on what will and won't work for our schedules in this season.

Focusing on one thing: We love to talk about our abilities to multitask, but our brains can truly only focus on one thing at a time. We trick ourselves into thinking we're actively doing many things at once, when really we're just bouncing around, stressing ourselves out and feeling chaotic. Instead, we can use our priorities list to guide us in focusing on tasks one by one. For everything from chores to debt payoff, we will be more likely to go further when we give our time, energy, and attention to one goal at a time.

Routines

You can think about routines as the actions you do regularly. You've got your morning routines, evening routines, before-bed routines, weekend routines, etc. When harnessed and used to our benefit, these consistent activities can allow us to reduce the number of daily decisions we need to make, thereby reducing decision fatigue. Which in turn frees up brain space to make the best decisions with our money and resources. When we've woven tasks into our schedule that benefit our spending, the whole thing feels simpler.